Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud 💸

UPI fraud is one of the most common cybercrimes today, especially among students and people who use online payments regularly. It usually happens when a scammer tricks someone into sending money or sharing sensitive details.

For example, a student selling books online gets a message from a “buyer.” The buyer says they will pay through UPI and sends a request. Instead of receiving money, the student is asked to enter their UPI PIN to “accept” the payment. Without realizing it, the student enters the PIN, and money gets deducted from their account. 😟

In many cases, scammers also call pretending to be bank officials or customer care agents. They create panic or urgency so the victim acts quickly without thinking. Sometimes they even send fake links or ask to install apps that give them access to the phone.

Mostly, students, elderly people, and those who are not very aware of digital scams become easy targets.

The consequences can be serious — loss of money, stress, and fear of using online services again.

This could be avoided by staying alert, never sharing UPI PINs, and remembering one simple rule: you don’t need to enter your PIN to receive money. ✅ Awareness is the best protection.